

AN ECLECTIC TECHNOLOGIES FOUNDATIONAL DEFINITION

FD — Foundational Definitions

October 2026 Edition — Contents and Edition Statement

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1. What this edition is

The Foundational Definitions are the instruments that own the concepts the rest of the corpus applies. A sector framework, a facility-class design basis, a vendor companion or an application guide uses the Bright Line, the Broker, the envelope, the determinism boundary and local sovereignty. It does not define them. This family does.

A concept belongs in this family when the correctness of other documents depends on agreeing what kind of thing it is. A concept with a settled external meaning, on which no document's correctness turns, does not belong here however important it is.

This is the family's third edition, and it is a repair edition. On 29 September 2026 the September 2026 Edition was reviewed cold, from the text of its published instruments alone, by a reviewer who had no access to the rest of the corpus. The review found eleven substantive findings, ten bearing on coherence and six editorial. This edition closes all twenty-seven. It supersedes the September 2026 Edition as the current statement of the family and does not withdraw it.

2. Contents

Designation	Title	Version	Class
FD-BL	The Bright Line	0.5	Foundational Definition
FD-LD	Layer Decomposition and Determinism	0.4	Foundational Definition
FD-EV	The Envelope	0.2	Foundational Definition

FD-BR	The Broker	0.11	Foundational Definition
FD-BL-D1	Mode of Discharge: Pre-Authorization by Verified Gatekeeper	0.5	Determination under FD-BL
FD-BL-D2	Indication Integrity: Trustworthy Basis for Authorization	0.4	Determination under FD-BL
FD-LS	Local Sovereignty	0.6	Foundational Definition
FD-REG	The Governing Stack Register	0.22	Companion register (dated copy)

Determinations are not Foundational Definitions. They settle a question the governing definition left open, under its authority, and are cited alongside it.

What DRAFT means in this family. Every instrument here is below version 1.0, and each carries DRAFT on its cover. In this family DRAFT means that the instrument is issued and citable at the version stated, and that its author does not yet hold it complete. It does not mean unreleased or provisional in force.

Dates. Each instrument's cover and administrative block carry the date of the version printed on it. The edition's date appears in its citation block and nowhere else.

FD-LS is originated by Project 5 of this portfolio, Grid Operations and Energy Policy, which holds the construct. The instrument here is its definition of record, kept with the rest of the family because that is where the corpus holds what every project inherits. Its own §2.3 states the origination and the lineage.

FD-REG is included as a companion and not as a member. It holds the version state of the family, and the bare citation form used throughout the corpus (FD-BL §4.2, without a version) resolves against it. The copy here is dated with the edition and records every member at the version listed above. After that date its master governs.

3. What changed since the September 2026 Edition

Every member moves by one version. The changes close the findings of the review of 29 September 2026 and follow five determinations the author made on 2 October 2026, together with the further decisions made while they were carried out. Placement remains consequence, action by action, throughout.

FD-BL, 0.4 to 0.5. §4.3 defines one action: one change an in-scope component's output would make, if executed or acted upon, to a process parameter, to a protective function, or to the pre-authorized envelope or the gatekeeper, individuated by the change it makes and assessed over its whole trajectory and rate. §4.2 places output that makes no change of its own below the line as a process action, and sends its role in grounding an authorization to FD-BL-D2. §4.4 now cites FD-LD §4.3 for the scope rule rather than restating it, so the September edition's statement that FD-BL §4.4 inherits the carve-out statement no longer describes the arrangement. §4.5 states that the Command Broker discharges in the moment or, where FD-BL-D1 applies, in advance, and §2.4 states that the architectural form of the obligation at §4.5 is normative.

FD-LD, 0.3 to 0.4. §4.3 carries the governing statement of scope: Bright Line analysis and the Command Broker obligation apply to every component that does not meet the carve-out, generative and other non-deterministic components being its principal cases and not its definition. “May operate autonomously” is gone, and the guard that the carve-out is not a grant of ungoverned autonomy is attached. §4.8 records two gaps, named and not closed.

FD-BR, 0.10 to 0.11. “Gate” names only the enforcement interlock, and the object that may stand in for a Broker’s presence is the verified gatekeeper. The envelope author is the Command Broker discharging in advance: one role, two modes. What a verified gatekeeper substitutes for is the Broker’s presence at the moment of action, not its judgment. The subtitle is restated to match.

FD-BL-D1, 0.4 to 0.5. §7’s reach clause no longer places an action above the line by its technology of origin; it states that an above-line action does not leave the obligation because an in-scope component’s contribution was indirect or partial. R2 points to FD-BL §4.3 for what one action is.

FD-BL-D2, 0.3 to 0.4. I1 attaches to the output of any in-scope component that can ground an above-line authorization or feed placement or discharge, and I3 requires in-the-moment Command Broker authorization for an action whose placement input cannot be corroborated, without changing its placement. The operative clause in §4 now says what it means.

FD-LS, 0.5 to 0.6. The third condition is split into an absolute limb at the time of acting and a conditional limb ahead of it, “governed act” is defined, and the physical-law condition takes FD-LD’s determinism test. Every locally sovereign function is a carved-out component.

FD-EV, 0.1 to 0.2. “Operating band” is confirmed, and a sector may use an established term of its own under the conditions in §4.3. “Governed act” cites FD-LS.

4. Precedence and propagation

Foundational Definitions take precedence over sector frameworks, facility-class documents, application guides, vendor companions, annexes, qualification standards and implementation guidance. A restatement may be expressed in sector vocabulary and may apply a definition to sector-specific actions. It shall not vary the placement criterion, the granularity, the scope of application or the obligation.

Propagation is by reference to the owning instrument, not by restating its text. An instrument that rebroadcasts its own wording re-introduces variance at every revision cycle.

5. What a reader needs from outside this family

The family applies a small number of things it does not define. A reader applying it needs them, and this section says where they are. It points and does not restate.

The severity threshold and the consequence-severity categories. FD-BL §4.2 places an action above the line when its incorrect performance could produce a consequence at or above “the severity threshold established for the facility.” The six consequence-severity categories, and the criticality bands built on them by taking the most severe, are stated in the Consequence-Severity Tier Model and applied in the Command Broker Framework, Cross-Sector, §3.3. The corpus assigns the band for an application in a given facility to that facility’s asset owner-operator, as the DBA-VC Vendor Companion states. This family does not say more than that about who establishes a facility’s threshold, and this edition does not settle it.

The qualification of a Broker. FD-BR §4.3 sets competence by the paired Line's placement criterion and makes qualification non-transferable. The competency instruments, onboarding and the advance-mode competence of the Command Broker are carried in the CB-IB Qualification and Onboarding Standard.

The citation form. The bare citation form, by designation and section without a version token, rests on the Corpus Rules note on citation form and the FD stack, and resolves against FD-REG.

6. What this edition asserts, and what it does not

An edition is a coherence claim, not merely a package.

This edition asserts that the seven instruments in §2, at the versions listed there, were read against one another on the date of issue, and that every cross-reference between them **resolves**. In this family a reference resolves when the cited section exists in the version cited and carries the content relied on, not merely when a section of that number exists. The read covered applications of each construct, tables included, and not only its statements.

It does not assert that the corpus applying these instruments has been conformed to them. Conformance of sector and application instruments is staged at each instrument's own next revision, and sibling projects whose instruments are affected were sent notes as each change was made. Where a sector document's statement of one of these constructs differs from the instrument here, the sector document is a restatement and the instrument here governs.

Coherence decays, and it decays fastest in the newest work. The edition date is the honest boundary of the claim.

7. Not in this edition

The surveillance branch is not in this edition: FD-SBL, the Surveillance Bright Line, with its determinations FD-SBL-D1 and FD-SBL-D2 and its register FD-SBL-REG. The branch belongs to Project 1 of this portfolio and is held from release pending external review. Two members of this edition depend on it, and the dependence is stated here rather than left for a reader to meet.

FD-BR cites FD-SBL §4.4, §4.5 and §6.1; FD-SBL-D1 §3, §4.3 and §5; FD-SBL-D2 §3.1 to §3.2, §4, §6, §7.1, §7.3 and §8; and FD-SBL-REG. These carry the Influence Broker's competence, its unit of authorization, its substitutability value and the ground of that value, and the permissible-influence boundary. FD-LD cites FD-SBL §4.4, for why the determinism carve-out does not transfer to the surveillance Line, and FD-SBL-REG. None of these references is satisfied within this edition. They will be when the branch is published.

Sector instantiation is not here by design. FD-BL-D1 §7 and FD-BL-D2 §7 are sector-neutral and delegate instantiation to sector annexes, which are separate instruments and are not part of this family.

8. Corpus-rule designators

Some instruments here name the corpus rules under which their own revisions were made. The rules are not part of this family and bind nothing here. They are glossed once so that a reader can follow the reference.

CR-AR, Act and Record: an act on a store and the record of that act are one obligation. CR-CC: a sentence asserting the currency, completeness or membership of a body beneath it is a claim about that body, and stands only if the body was read. CR-CF: an instrument meant to be inherited is cited without a version token, and only where a current register holds its version. CR-CO, Capture Before Overwrite: what is owed to a store about to be made to agree. CR-DP: designation prefixes are allocated corpus-wide, not per series. CR-OT, Ownership Transfer: what is owed when a concept changes owners. CR-PB, Publication Boundary: what a published artifact owes when its master moves. CR-SC, Standing Change: a change in what the corpus holds true about itself. CR-TA, Terminal Artifact Read: a rendered artifact is read through before it leaves the project. CR-VA, Verification Against Applications: a conformance pass searches the applications of a construct, not only its statements.

9. How to cite

Cite the concept DOI for the definitions as they currently stand, and the version DOI to pin this edition. Within a citation, name the instrument and section: FD-BL §4.2, in *FD — Foundational Definitions, October 2026 Edition*. The instrument's own version number is printed on its cover and in its citation block, and FD-REG holds it.

10. Revision policy

Instruments revise on their own schedules and carry their own version numbers. A change to any instrument does not by itself publish a new edition. An edition is cut when the author judges that the family has moved enough to warrant a new coherence claim, and each edition is published as a new version under the same concept DOI. The editions therefore record which combinations of versions were coherent together. That is the property a corpus built on propagation by reference most needs and most easily loses.